



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 17 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 19 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A strong high pressure system south of the state will maintain a ridge across SA for the next few days as it drifts eastwards, to be located over NSW from Friday. A cold front is then likely to approach from the west late Saturday and move across SA on Sunday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning northeasterly in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly in the early morning then decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.